

Onboarding, Encouragement & Human Engagement

How Cliplo should introduce itself, demonstrate its core experience, earn trust through attention to detail, and make “clipping” feel worth building over time.

The onboarding should not explain a clipboard manager. It should make people feel the relief of never having to hunt for something they already had.

Primary product promise

Copy once. Use anytime.

Working principle: Onboarding sells the outcome. Setup explains the mechanics. The product earns belief afterward.

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1. What onboarding is supposed to accomplish

Goal	What “good” looks like
Create recognition	The user should recognize situations from their own day: copying an address, a link, a number, a message, a product, a useful paragraph, or code they will want again.
Demonstrate the payoff	Show the copied thing returning exactly when it is needed. Do not lead with folders, search, Vault, classification, or clipboard history.
Make clipping feel authored	“Clipping” should feel like a small, satisfying act: useful information is pocketed, remembered, and ready to come back.
Establish trust	Cliplo should feel attentive without being invasive. It notices patterns, avoids clutter, protects private content, and never makes the user feel managed.
Create the first win	The user should complete onboarding with at least one real clip and understand how to retrieve it.

The emotional sequence

- 01 I do that all the time.
- 02 Wait — it remembers that?
- 03 Oh, I can get it back from where I am.
- 04 It is already organizing itself.
- 05 This feels like something that will become more useful the longer I keep it.

2. Product principles for the onboarding

Outcome before infrastructure

Never introduce Cliplo with “clipboard manager,” “clipboard history,” “automatic classification,” or a feature grid. Show what the person gets back.

Recognition before education

Use familiar, believable examples before explaining how anything works.

Show, do not claim

An animation of an address being retrieved is more persuasive than “search your clips instantly.”

Encouragement without gamification

Celebrate usefulness and reuse. Avoid streaks, XP, levels, leaderboards, confetti for trivial actions, or rewards for copying junk.

Human, not chatty

A small amount of authored copy is powerful. Constant personality becomes noise. Most successful capture should be quiet.

Attention as value

Duplicate handling, clean links, sensitive-content protection, useful suggestions, and resurfacing are “invisible favors” that prove Cliplo is working.

Progressive disclosure

Let onboarding stay simple. Explain privacy, permissions, trial rules, Vault, and keyboard setup only when they become relevant.

Never overpromise Android behavior

Animations and copy must reflect real capture constraints. When the OS requires a setup step or alternative capture path, explain it clearly instead of pretending capture is universal.

3. Recommended onboarding storyboard

Keep the experience to five emotional moments, followed by setup. Each screen should have one message, one primary action, and one memorable visual behavior.

01

The magic

Copy once. Use anytime.

Visual: A delivery address is copied in another context, visibly “clips” into Cliplo, then returns later when someone asks for it.

Purpose: Make the value obvious in seconds. No product vocabulary yet.

Primary action: Continue

02**Recognition****You already copy things worth keeping.**

Visual: A sequence of real things: delivery address, restaurant, product link, phone number, useful paragraph, code, message. Each is shown as content, not as a category chip.

Purpose: Help the user see their own behavior in Cliplo.

Primary action: Show me

03**The memory forms****The more you use Cliplo, the more useful it becomes.**

Visual: Clips accumulate into a calm personal library. Similar items subtly gather; duplicate content does not multiply.

Purpose: Introduce the idea of a growing personal memory without selling “organization.”

Primary action: Continue

04**Retrieval where it matters****Right there when you need it.**

Visual: A user starts typing in another app, opens Cliplo from the keyboard/retrieval surface, searches “address,” taps once, and pastes.

Purpose: Show the core experience: reuse from the point of need.

Primary action: Continue

05**The human handoff****Start building your Cliplo.**

Visual: A short founder/product note and a single real-life example. The tone is warm, restrained, and not startup-performative.

Purpose: Turn interest into action and establish that the product was made with intent.

Primary action: Start clipping

4. The “clipping” interaction: make the core action feel good

The word “clip” should become Cliplo’s own verb. The interaction should feel like pocketing something useful—not filing a record into a database.

Motion signature

Copied content compresses slightly, snaps into a compact Cliplo shape, and settles into the library. Avoid paperclip clichés unless they feel exceptionally refined.

Haptics

Use one light, crisp haptic for meaningful capture confirmation. Do not vibrate for every background classification event.

Sound

Default to silent. If a capture sound is ever offered, make it optional and extremely subtle.

Timing

Successful capture feedback should feel immediate. The motion can complete quickly while enrichment/metadata continues silently afterward.

Language

Prefer “Clipped”, “Remembered”, “Ready when you need it”, “Already got it”, and “Still here.” Avoid database language such as “record inserted” or “duplicate ignored.”

Reduced motion

Replace snap/flight animations with opacity, scale, and state changes. The meaning must survive without motion.

5. Invisible favors: the moments that make Cliplo feel intelligent

These moments are not onboarding-only. They are the proof, after onboarding, that Cliplo actually pays attention. Use them sparingly so each one still feels earned.

Moment	Cliplo behavior	Primary copy	Alternate copy	UX rule
Duplicate copied again	Do not save a second copy. Bring the existing clip forward, increment its copy/reuse signal, and keep the library clean.	Already got it.	We remember this one.	No modal. Short toast or capture feedback only.

Moment	Cliplo behavior	Primary copy	Alternate copy	UX rule
Repeatedly reused clip	Recognize that it matters and offer a low-pressure shortcut.	You use this a lot. Keep it close?	One of your regulars.	Suggestion can be dismissed and should not immediately reappear.
Repeated source/pattern	Suggest a collection only when the grouping is meaningful and obvious.	Looks like these belong together.	Create a YouTube collection?	Preview before creation; user confirms.
Sensitive content	Protect the user without sounding alarmist.	This looks private. Keep it hidden?	Protect with Vault	Never show sensitive content in the notification itself.
Old item rediscovered	Reward continuity rather than novelty.	Still here.	You clipped this 4 months ago.	Use only when the age is meaningful; avoid making every search sentimental.
Messy tracked URL	Keep the canonical useful link and quietly remove noise when safe.	Saved the clean link.	Cleaned that up for you.	Optional feedback; do not interrupt capture.
Meaningful reuse milestone	Reflect value created, not amount hoarded.	You've reused 100 things with Cliplo.	100 things you didn't have to find again.	Celebrate occasionally; no confetti blast required.

6. Encouragement and engagement system

Cliplo should encourage the user when it can point to real value. It should not manufacture engagement for its own sake.

6.1 What to celebrate

Moment	Example copy	Why it matters
First clip	You clipped your first thing.	Establish the core behavior.
First successful reuse	There it is.	This is more important than the first capture because it proves the promise.
Reuse milestones	You've reused 50 things with Cliplo.	Directly measures value delivered.
Library milestones	1,000 things remembered.	Use rarely, and connect the count to memory—not status.
Long-term continuity	Six months of Cliplo.	Acknowledge the artifact the person has built.

Moment	Example copy	Why it matters
Helpful pattern recognized	You use this a lot. Keep it close?	Turn observed behavior into a useful suggestion.

6.2 What not to reward

- Copying lots of random content
- Daily streak maintenance
- Opening the app when there is nothing useful to do
- Artificial “engagement” loops
- XP for basic capture
- Competitive counts or social comparison

6.3 Milestone hierarchy

Tier A — value milestones

First reuse; 10, 50, 100, 500, 1,000 reuses.

Strongest celebrations. These prove Cliplo saved effort.

Tier B — memory milestones

50, 100, 250, 500, 1,000, 2,000, 5,000 clips.

Occasional and quieter. Never imply that more storage is inherently better.

Tier C — relationship milestones

30 days, 6 months, 1 year of active use.

Rare “look what you built” moments, ideally with useful stats.

7. Notifications: useful enough to deserve interruption

A notification is not a celebration channel by default. It is an interruption. Cliplo should notify only when the message has clear value outside the app.

Policy	Trigger	Guidance / example
Allowed	Rare meaningful milestone	“500 things reused. That’s 500 things you didn’t have to find again.”
Allowed	A user-requested reminder or explicit workflow	Only when the user opted into that workflow.
Allowed with care	Sensitive-content safety event	Never reveal the secret in the notification preview.
Usually in-app	Duplicate detected	“Already got it.” should normally be a toast/capture response, not a system notification.
Usually in-app	Collection suggestion	Keep it inside Collections/capture area so it feels helpful, not needy.
Avoid	Routine capture success	Do not generate a notification every time something is copied.
Avoid	Streak loss / guilt	Cliplo should never pressure people to copy things just to maintain a number.

8. Founder touches and making Cliplo feel human

Founder presence should feel like evidence that real people care about the product—not personal branding pasted over the interface.

Recommended founder touchpoints

End of onboarding

A 2–3 sentence note about the annoyance that led to Cliplo.

Example: “We kept copying the same addresses, links and messages, then hunting for them again. That felt ridiculous. So we made Cliplo remember them.”

Privacy / About

A concise point of view about local-first ownership.

Example: “Useful memory does not need to mean giving your clipboard to a server.”

Major product milestone

An occasional release note or anniversary message written like a person.

Example: Talk about what got better for the user, not engineering vanity metrics.

Empty / edge states

Tiny authored microcopy where warmth improves the moment.

Example: *“Nothing here yet. Go find something worth keeping.”*

Founder presence should never become

- A portrait on every onboarding screen
- “Hey, I’m the founder!” before the user understands the product
- Long letters the user must read to continue
- A substitute for clear UX
- Constant jokes, memes, or forced casual language

9. Voice and microcopy system

Cliplo’s voice should be observant, calm, concise, lightly warm, and confident. It should sound like a product that noticed something useful—not a mascot asking for attention.

Moment	Prefer	Avoid
Capture	Clipped.	Saved successfully!
Duplicate	Already got it.	Duplicate detected.
Old item	Still here.	Item found in history.
Reuse	There it is.	Paste successful.
Frequent item	One of your regulars.	Frequently used item detected.
Clean URL	Cleaned that up for you.	Tracking parameters removed.
Collection suggestion	Looks like these belong together.	Smart grouping recommendation available.
Sensitive item	This looks private. Keep it hidden?	Sensitive content detected.
Empty state	Go find something worth keeping.	No clipboard entries.
Import complete	Everything made it.	Import successful.
Milestone	2,000 things remembered.	You reached 2,000 clipboard entries.
Reuse milestone	100 things you didn’t have to find again.	100 reuses achieved.

10. Separate onboarding from setup

The product story should make the user want Cliplo before Cliplo asks them to understand Android permissions, keyboard setup, capture limitations, or trial rules.

Stage	What happens	Rule
Experience	Show the problem and outcome.	No permission dialogs. No technical jargon.
Intent	User chooses “Start clipping.”	Now we know there is motivation to continue.
Setup: capture	Explain what Cliplo can capture, what Android restricts, and the available capture paths.	Use one clear reason before each system permission or system-settings jump.
First real clip	Ask the user to copy/paste/share one harmless sample or their own content.	Celebrate first successful capture with restraint.
Setup: retrieval	Show/enable keyboard or quick retrieval surface when appropriate.	Teach one action: find → tap → paste.
Privacy	Explain local-first behavior at the point trust matters.	Be specific, not vague “we value privacy” language.
Trial / Pro	Explain the seven-day full experience after value is understood.	Do not interrupt the product story with pricing before the user sees the magic.
Handoff	Open the real library with the first clip already present.	No dead empty dashboard after onboarding.

11. First-session experience after onboarding

The first 10 minutes should reinforce the promise without turning into a tutorial checklist.

1 Land in a real library

The first captured clip is already visible. Avoid an empty “welcome” shell.

2 One contextual hint

Point to the fastest retrieval/copy action, then disappear permanently once used.

3 First reuse

When the user reuses the first clip, acknowledge it with a tiny “There it is.” moment.

4 First invisible favor

If a duplicate or clear pattern occurs, let Cliplo handle it quietly and explain only the benefit.

5 No tour of every tab

Collections, Vault, filters, templates, and deeper organization can introduce themselves when the user has a reason to care.

12. Attention-to-detail checklist

Motion & responsiveness

- Every primary action reacts immediately, even if enrichment continues later.
- Avoid long entrance animations that slow repeat users.
- Use one recognizable Cliplo motion signature across onboarding and capture feedback.
- Respect reduced-motion settings.
- Keep transitions spatially coherent: the clip should appear to go somewhere, not simply vanish.

Copy & hierarchy

- One strong sentence per onboarding screen.
- Supporting text should fit in roughly two short lines when possible.
- Buttons use verbs: “Start clipping”, “Show me”, “Continue”.
- Never stack several claims on the same screen.
- Avoid describing implementation unless setup requires it.

Touch & accessibility

- Minimum 44dp touch targets.
- Large system font should not hide the primary action.
- Do not encode clip type/state by color alone.
- Animations must not be required to understand what happened.
- Haptic feedback should have a setting or respect platform accessibility expectations.

Trust

- Never expose sensitive clip content in onboarding examples, previews, or notifications.
- Always explain what a permission enables before triggering the OS dialog.
- Make skip/postpone possible for optional setup.
- Do not imply background capture works in situations Android does not permit.
- Tell the user what remains local in plain language.

Restraint

- No confetti for normal capture.
- No repeated “tips” after the user has demonstrated mastery.
- Do not make every intelligent behavior visible. Many favors should stay invisible.
- Do not ask for ratings, sharing, or referrals during initial onboarding.

- Do not interrupt a successful copy/paste workflow with a modal.

13. Edge cases the onboarding must handle gracefully

Permission denied

Do not frame it as failure. Explain what Cliplo can still do and provide the next best capture method.

Keyboard setup postponed

Let the user enter the app. Reintroduce keyboard setup later when they attempt a reuse workflow where it helps.

No clip captured during setup

Seed a clearly labeled demo clip only if necessary, but do not pretend it came from the user.

Duplicate is the first clip

Treat it as normal. The “already got it” behavior should still make sense without implying data loss.

Sensitive item copied during setup

Redact it immediately; do not use it as a celebratory onboarding example.

Reduced motion

Replace movement with state changes and concise text confirmation.

Returning/reinstalled user

Avoid replaying the full story if prior state or an imported library makes the user clearly experienced.

Free limit/trial state

Never surprise the user by deleting data. Explain limits before they affect behavior; older clips should remain retained rather than silently removed.

14. What to measure

Do not optimize onboarding completion in isolation. A person can complete every screen and still fail to understand Cliplo. Measure whether they experience the promise.

Metric	Definition	Interpretation
Story completion	% reaching “Start clipping”	Basic funnel health only.
First real capture	% capturing a real clip in first session	Shows setup clarity.

Metric	Definition	Interpretation
First reuse	% reusing any clip within 24h / 7d	Best early proof that the product delivered.
Time to first reuse	Minutes/hours between first capture and first reuse	Should trend down as retrieval UX improves.
Duplicate favor observed	% of active users who encounter dedup behavior	Useful as qualitative magic, not a target to force.
Suggestion acceptance	Accepted vs dismissed collection/keep-close suggestions	Tests whether Cliplo notices meaningful patterns.
Notification disable rate	% disabling Cliplo notifications after enablement	A warning signal for over-communication.
Reuse per active clip	Reuses divided by clips retained	Better long-term signal than raw library size.

15. Launch review: questions every onboarding build must pass

- Can a new user describe Cliplo's value without saying "clipboard manager"?
- Does the first screen show an outcome rather than a feature?
- Does every onboarding screen have exactly one dominant message?
- Do the examples look like things a normal person actually copies?
- Does the animation show reuse—not just storage?
- Is "clipping" visually satisfying without becoming gimmicky?
- Is the first permission request preceded by a clear reason?
- Can optional setup be postponed without trapping the user?
- Does the user reach the real app with at least one useful clip?
- Are duplicate copies handled without clutter?
- Are celebrations tied primarily to reuse/value?
- Do notifications deserve to interrupt the user?
- Does founder copy feel authored rather than performative?
- Could any animation or line of copy overpromise Android capture behavior?
- Does the experience still make sense with reduced motion and large text?

16. North star

The best Cliplo moment is not “look how many features this app has.”

It is the moment the user thinks: “I didn’t even know I needed that — and it already handled it for me.”

Onboarding should promise that feeling. The product must keep earning it.

17. Source basis and alignment

This specification consolidates the current Cliplo product direction and the onboarding discussion. It is aligned with the project’s existing decisions: outcome-first onboarding; local-first behavior; Smart Collections as suggestions rather than forced automation; calm/premium visual language; keyboard retrieval as a core expression of the promise; duplicate/canonical identity handling; and retention of older clips rather than silent deletion.

- README.md
- FEATURES.md
- MUST_HAVE_FEATURES.md
- PRODUCT_UX_DECISIONS.md
- VISUAL_FEATURES.md
- STACK.md